

D754

Special Education Law, Policies and Procedures

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A fourth grader with autism has made almost no progress on reading goals for three years; each IEP repeats the same goals. The district just opened a new sensory room and the student rides a special bus. The parents ask whether the IEP meets the legal standard. What is the best answer?

- A. Yes, because some benefit, however small, is enough.
- B. Yes, because the district has a new sensory room.
- C. Likely not; an IEP must be reasonably calculated for progress appropriate to the child's circumstances, and repeating unmet goals is a warning sign.
- D. No, because FAPE requires the best possible program.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A district proposes moving a second grader with a learning disability to a separate classroom because the resource room is full. She is making progress in general education with a co-teacher. The school recently won a state award. What does LRE require?

- A. Move her, since the resource room is full.
- B. Keep her in general education with supports, since she is succeeding there.
- C. Move her, since students with disabilities should be served together.
- D. Keep her in general education without any supports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When is a more restrictive placement justified under LRE?

- A. When the student cannot make satisfactory progress in general education even with supplementary aids and services.
- B. When the general education teacher prefers it.
- C. When the student has a certain disability category.
- D. Never; all students must be in general education full time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A high school student with type 1 diabetes needs blood sugar checks and snacks but earns A's and B's with no need for special instruction. Her mother is a nurse and the school has a new cafeteria. Which plan fits?

- A. A Section 504 plan with health accommodations.
- B. A cafeteria meal plan only.
- C. No plan, since her grades are good.
- D. An IEP under IDEA.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student with a 504 plan for ADHD is now failing reading despite accommodations, and testing shows a specific learning disability. What should happen?

- A. Add more 504 accommodations only.
- B. Remove the 504 plan because it failed.
- C. The team should consider IDEA eligibility and an IEP with specially designed instruction.
- D. Wait a year to see if grades improve.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

On March 1, a parent who works as a pharmacist asks to see all of her son's special education records before his IEP meeting on March 10. The school just switched student information systems. What must the school do?

- A. Delay until the new system is fully working.
- B. Allow access within 45 days, which could be after the meeting.
- C. Refuse, since records belong to the school.
- D. Allow her to inspect the records before the March 10 meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A parent signed consent for an initial evaluation. The team found her son eligible, but she refuses to consent to special education services. The boy is new to the state and loves drawing. What can the district do?

- A. Start services, since she consented to the evaluation.
- B. Not provide services; it cannot use due process to override refusal of initial services.
- C. Offer an art class instead of services.
- D. File for due process to force services.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which step requires its own separate written parental consent?

- A. Nothing after the evaluation, since it covers all later steps.
- B. A teacher reviewing classwork samples.
- C. Every weekly progress probe.
- D. The first provision of special education services after eligibility.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A district proposes moving a student from a general education class to a separate program. The parents file a due process complaint. The student's older sister attends college nearby, and the district's new superintendent supports the move. Where does the student attend while the complaint is pending?

- A. The current general education placement, unless parents and district agree otherwise.
- B. The separate program the district proposed.
- C. At home until the hearing ends.
- D. Wherever the superintendent decides.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

During a pending due process hearing, the parents and district both agree the student should try a new co-taught class. Can the student move?

- A.** Yes, but only if the hearing officer orders it first.
- B.** No; the placement can never change until the hearing ends.
- C.** No, because stay-put keeps the district's proposed placement.
- D.** Yes; stay-put allows a change when parents and district agree.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A family disagrees with a district about how many speech minutes their child needs. Both want a quick, private way to try to agree, with a neutral person helping. The family recently moved into a larger house. Which option fits?

- A.** A hearing, because mediation is always required first.
- B.** A state complaint
- C.** Mediation
- D.** A due process hearing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A principal who was just named administrator of the year tells a special education teacher to stop providing a student's IEP reading minutes because of a staffing shortage. The school has a new reading coach. What does the CEC code call for?

- A.** Report the principal to the news media.
- B.** Explain the IEP obligation, keep providing the service if possible, and raise it through proper channels, documenting the concern.
- C.** Ask the reading coach to take over the IEP.
- D.** Stop the minutes, since the principal is the supervisor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A fourth grader with autism has made almost no progress on reading goals for three years; each IEP repeats the same goals. ~~The district just opened a new sensory room and the student rides a special bus.~~ The parents ask whether the IEP meets the legal standard. What is the best answer?

Target word: apply FAPE standard **Decides:** Repeated minimal progress with no change.

A	Inverted operation	Endrew F. rejected the minimal-benefit reading.
B	Camouflage	Facilities do not decide whether the IEP is appropriate.
C	Correct	Endrew F. requires appropriately ambitious progress.
D	Absolute language	FAPE is not a 'best possible' standard.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A district proposes moving a second grader with a learning disability to a separate classroom because the resource room is full. She is making progress in general education with a co-teacher. ~~The school recently won a state award.~~ What does LRE require?

Target word: LRE decision **Decides:** She is succeeding in general education with supports.

A	Adjacent category	Space is not a legal basis for placement.
B	Correct	Removal is allowed only when supports cannot achieve success.
C	Absolute language	Placement is individual, not by label.
D	Dropped element	Drops the supplementary aids that make LRE work.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

When is a more restrictive placement justified under LRE?

Target word: reverse: when removal is allowed **Decides:** Supports tried and education is not satisfactory.

A	Correct	That is the legal condition for removal.
B	Adjacent category	Preference is not a legal basis.
C	Confusion set	Category does not decide placement.
D	Absolute language	LRE includes a continuum of placements.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A high school student with type 1 diabetes needs blood sugar checks and snacks but earns A's and B's with no need for special instruction. ~~Her mother is a nurse and the school has a new cafeteria.~~ Which plan fits?

Target word: 504 vs. IEP **Decides:** Impairment limits a life activity; no need for specially designed instruction.

A	Correct	She has a limiting impairment but does not need specialized instruction.
B	Camouflage	Uses the cafeteria detail; not a legal plan.
C	Dropped element	Drops the substantial limitation to a major life activity.
D	Adjacent category	IDEA also requires a need for specially designed instruction.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A student with a 504 plan for ADHD is now failing reading despite accommodations, and testing shows a specific learning disability. What should happen?

Target word: reverse: move from 504 to IDEA **Decides:** Now needs specially designed instruction in a listed category.

A	Inverted operation	Accommodations alone do not provide the needed instruction.
B	Dropped element	Drops needed supports.
C	Correct	A qualifying disability plus need for SDI triggers IDEA.
D	Absolute language	Delay denies needed services.

6. Answer D Concept 4

On March 1, a parent ~~who works as a pharmacist~~ asks to see all of her son's special education records before his IEP meeting on March 10. ~~The school just switched student information systems.~~ What must the school do?

Target word: records access timing **Decides:** Request made before a scheduled IEP meeting.

A	Camouflage	A system change does not suspend access rights.
B	Dropped element	Drops the before-a-meeting requirement.
C	Inverted operation	Parents have a right to inspect.
D	Correct	Access must come before an IEP meeting, even if under 45 days.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A parent signed consent for an initial evaluation. The team found her son eligible, but she refuses to consent to special education services. ~~The boy is new to the state and loves drawing.~~ What can the district do?

Target word: effect of refusing services **Decides:** Parent refused consent for initial services.

A	Confusion set	Evaluation consent is not service consent.
B	Correct	Consent for services is separate and cannot be overridden.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.
D	Inverted operation	IDEA bars overriding refusal of initial services.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which step requires its own separate written parental consent?

Target word: reverse: identify a consent event **Decides:** Initial provision of services.

A	Dropped element	Drops the separate consent for services.
B	Adjacent category	Routine review of work does not need consent.
C	Absolute language	Routine instructional assessment does not require consent.
D	Correct	Initial services need separate informed consent.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A district proposes moving a student from a general education class to a separate program. The parents file a due process complaint. ~~The student's older sister attends college nearby, and the district's new superintendent supports the move.~~ Where does the student attend while the complaint is pending?

Target word: placement during dispute **Decides:** Due process complaint pending.

A	Correct	Stay-put keeps the current placement.
B	Inverted operation	The proposed change cannot proceed during the dispute.
C	Adjacent category	Removes services without legal basis.
D	Camouflage	Authority does not override stay-put.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

During a pending due process hearing, the parents and district both agree the student should try a new co-taught class. Can the student move?

Target word: reverse: the stay-put exception **Decides:** Stay-put yields to agreement of both parties.

A	Adjacent category	Agreement alone is enough.
B	Absolute language	Ignores the agreement exception.
C	Inverted operation	Stay-put protects the current placement, not the proposal.
D	Correct	Mutual agreement is the stated exception.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A family disagrees with a district about how many speech minutes their child needs. Both want a quick, private way to try to agree, with a neutral person helping. ~~The family recently moved into a larger house.~~ Which option fits?

Target word: pick the process **Decides:** Voluntary, confidential, neutral helper.

A	Absolute language	Mediation is voluntary.
B	Confusion set	An investigation of a violation, not a helped agreement.
C	Correct	Voluntary, confidential, with a neutral mediator.
D	Adjacent category	A formal hearing where an officer decides.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A principal ~~who was just named administrator of the year~~ tells a special education teacher to stop providing a student's IEP reading minutes because of a staffing shortage. ~~The school has a new reading coach.~~ What does the CEC code call for?

Target word: ethical response **Decides:** A directive conflicts with the IEP.

A	Adjacent category	Not a proper channel and risks student privacy.
B	Correct	Students' needs and legal duties come first, addressed through proper channels.
C	Camouflage	Uses the coach; changes to services need the IEP team.
D	Inverted operation	A supervisor cannot waive an IEP.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	FAPE after Rowley and Endrew F.	A free appropriate public education requires an IEP reasonably calculated to enable progress appropriate in light of the child's circumstances (Endrew F., 2017), a higher bar than bare 'some benefit,' but not the best possible education (Rowley, 1982).	Thinking FAPE means the best possible program, or that minimal progress is enough.	A dispute over whether an IEP is ambitious enough.
2	Least restrictive environment	Students with disabilities are educated with nondisabled peers to the maximum extent appropriate; removal happens only when education there cannot be achieved satisfactorily with supplementary aids and services.	Choosing placement by disability label, available space, or convenience.	A placement decision that moves a student out of general education.
3	Section 504 vs. IDEA	Section 504 covers any student with a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits a major life activity; IDEA covers students in listed categories who need specially designed instruction.	Assuming every student with a diagnosis qualifies for an IEP.	A student with a condition who does not need specialized instruction.
4	Parent access to education records	Under FERPA and IDEA, parents may inspect their child's education records; schools must respond without unnecessary delay, before any IEP meeting or hearing, and within 45 days.	Believing teachers' records are secret from parents or that schools may take any amount of time.	A parent asks to see records before a meeting.
5	Consent to evaluate vs. consent for services	Parental consent for initial evaluation is separate from consent for initial services; if parents refuse initial services, the district cannot override that through due process.	Treating consent to evaluate as consent to place in special education.	A parent agreed to testing but not to services.
6	Stay-put	While a due process complaint is pending, the student stays in the current educational placement unless the parents and district agree otherwise.	Letting the district carry out its proposed change during the dispute.	A placement dispute and a pending hearing.
7	Dispute resolution options	Mediation is voluntary and confidential; a state complaint alleges a violation (within one year); a due process complaint goes to a hearing officer (generally within two years).	Thinking mediation is required or that it decides who is right.	A family and district disagree and a process must be named.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	CEC ethics: practicing within competence and advocacy	CEC ethical principles call for practicing within one's professional competence, putting students' needs first, and using proper channels to address practices that violate law or policy.	Following an illegal directive because a supervisor gave it.	A supervisor asks for something that conflicts with the IEP or law.

Course scope (public description): Special Education Law, Policies, and Procedures prepares special education teachers to practice within legal and ethical guidelines as they navigate the Special Education processes, stakeholder interactions, and other complex situations. This course provides an overview of the professional ethics and professional practice standards of the Council for Exceptional Children (CEC), which guides candidates to act in a professionally conscientious manner. Candidates will explore special education legal foundations and case laws to apply legal foundations and ethical practices in special education process compliance.